intersex
NIGERIA
CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT & YOUTH EMPOWERMENT

# INTERSEX NIGERIA

## (CENTER FOR HEALTHCARE DEVELOPMENT AND YOUTH EMPOWERMENT)

# ANNUAL REPORT 2023

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# *Vision &* Mission

## Vision

*Our vision is to see a society where intersex persons, from birth, have rights to bodily integrity and autonomy and are free from stigma and discrimination.*

## Mission

*To create an enabling society that promotes the visibility, inclusion, bodily autonomy, sexual and reproductive health including mental wellbeing and human rights of intersex persons in Nigeria, through community organizing, research, advocacy and public engagements using a feminist lens.*

# Objectives

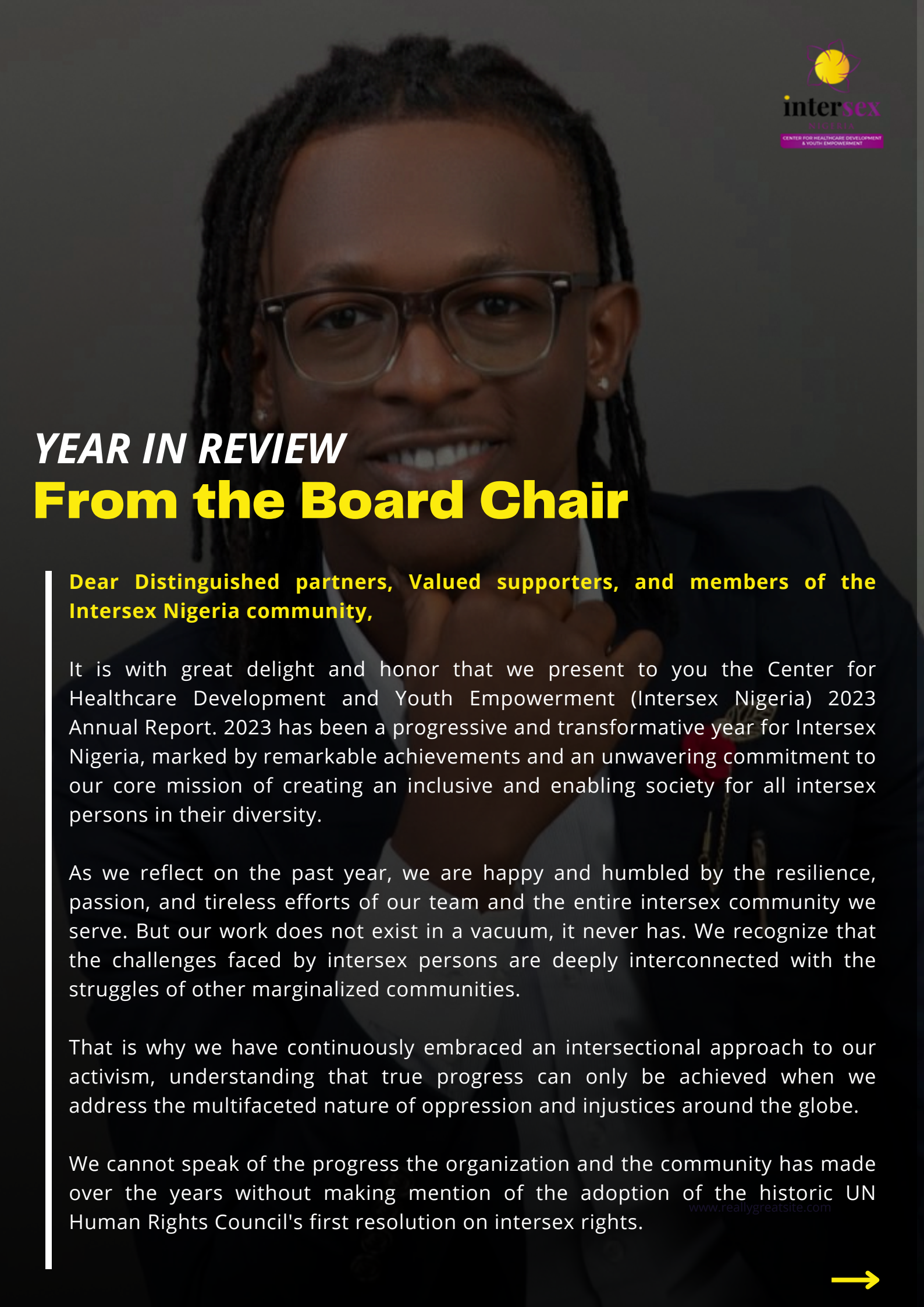
- **Advocacy:** Lead advocacy efforts and strategies to influence and sustain policies and laws that protect and promote intersex rights.

- **Empowerment and Support:** Establish and maintain a comprehensive support network for intersex persons and their families, through online and in-person forums and activities.

- **Information and Education:** Utilizing digital platforms and printed materials to distribute developed accessible educational resources on intersex issues, to broaden public awareness and understanding of intersex rights and needs.

- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Increase recognition and support for intersex rights by securing commitments from key stakeholders across healthcare, legal, policy, human rights and other sectors, ensuring their active participation in initiatives for intersex individuals.

- **Strategic Partnerships:** Form strategic partnerships with organizations that align with our mission, through movement building, resource mobilization, and collaborations to support key human rights initiatives.



*YEAR IN REVIEW*

# From the Board Chair

**Dear Distinguished partners, Valued supporters, and members of the Intersex Nigeria community,**

It is with great delight and honor that we present to you the Center for Healthcare Development and Youth Empowerment (Intersex Nigeria) 2023 Annual Report. 2023 has been a progressive and transformative year for Intersex Nigeria, marked by remarkable achievements and an unwavering commitment to our core mission of creating an inclusive and enabling society for all intersex persons in their diversity.

As we reflect on the past year, we are happy and humbled by the resilience, passion, and tireless efforts of our team and the entire intersex community we serve. But our work does not exist in a vacuum, it never has. We recognize that the challenges faced by intersex persons are deeply interconnected with the struggles of other marginalized communities.

That is why we have continuously embraced an intersectional approach to our activism, understanding that true progress can only be achieved when we address the multifaceted nature of oppression and injustices around the globe.

We cannot speak of the progress the organization and the community has made over the years without making mention of the adoption of the historic UN Human Rights Council's first resolution on intersex rights.

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This landmark event reaffirmed our commitment to the global fight against discrimination and violence, and we are proud to have played a role in advocating for this significant milestone as an organization and a community. We can only hope that this global achievement will be localized for the wellbeing and inclusion of intersex persons in all their diversity in Nigeria.

As we look to the future, we remain steadfast in our commitment to absolute inclusion. We will continue to support and empower intersex persons and their families, lead and contribute to policy-making processes, and raise awareness and recognition of intersex rights. Through our partnerships and collaborations, we will amplify the voices of the intersex community and work tirelessly to create a more inclusive and just society. But we cannot do this alone. Our sincere gratitude goes to all civil society organizations, non-governmental organizations, and allies who join us in this fight for equality and justice. Together, we will continue working towards embracing an intersectional approach, recognizing the interconnectedness of our struggles, and the power of collective action.

We would also like to take this opportunity to express our heartfelt gratitude to our dedicated management team, workforce, volunteers, community members, and all our supporters who have stood by us throughout this journey. Your unwavering commitment and generosity have been instrumental in the success of this entity. We celebrate all your 'little' wins and would like to tell you that, really, that's what it takes - with a dash of consistency - to build the future we want for our communities.

There is already evidence of inevitable challenges ahead, but we find solace in our drive to continuously pursue our vision for a better Nigeria (and world) for intersex persons and the relentless support of everyone who has been around us.

We cannot wait to write to you again in the coming year to celebrate the concerted effort we all put in for this cause. In the meantime, never lose hope, and keep making conscious positive differences wherever you find yourself.

**Sincerely, Thank you!!!**

**Daniel Adams**

***Board Chair***

***On behalf of Intersex Nigeria BOARD***

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*YEAR IN REVIEW*

# From the Executive Director

**Dear Partners, Allies, and Members of the Intersex Community,**

As I reflect on the past year, I am filled with immense pride and gratitude for the strides we have made together at Intersex Nigeria. The year 2023 has been a period of significant growth, tireless advocacy, and powerful movement-building. Our collective efforts have led to remarkable achievements that continue to pave the way for a more inclusive and just society for intersex persons in Nigeria.

## Advocacy and Visibility

One of our most significant achievements this year was the launch of the VIRAL Project, a groundbreaking initiative aimed at uncovering the prevalence of intersex genital mutilation (IGM) in Nigeria and Cameroon. The project's inception and subsequent progress meetings were crucial in bringing together key stakeholders, including human rights organizations, traditional leaders, and law enforcement agencies, to address this critical issue. The successful validation of research reports and the development of a costed action plan have laid a strong foundation for our ongoing advocacy efforts.

→

## Human Rights and Public Engagement

Our commitment to human rights was further demonstrated through various initiatives, including the Pride Symposium, which focused on the narrative of intersex within the broader SOGIESC movement. This event, alongside our vibrant Intersex Awareness Day celebration, served as platforms for raising awareness, challenging stigma, and fostering a supportive community for intersex persons.

In addition to these high-profile events, our radio outreach programs on Ikorodu FM and Star FM have been instrumental in reaching diverse audiences, including those in remote and underserved areas. These programs have allowed us to educate the public, debunk myths, and engage in meaningful dialogues about intersex issues.

## Youth Empowerment and Capacity Building

Youth empowerment remains at the core of our mission. Through initiatives like the Engage, Encourage, Empower (EEE) program and our NYSC sensitization sessions, we have equipped young individuals with the knowledge, skills, and confidence to advocate for their rights and those of others. These programs have not only educated but also transformed lives, fostering a new generation of informed and empathetic advocates for intersex rights.

## Looking Forward

As we look ahead to 2024, we are more determined than ever to expand our reach, strengthen our advocacy efforts, and build new partnerships. Our vision of a society where intersex persons are free from stigma and discrimination continues to drive our work. With your continued support, we will empower more individuals, amplify our impact, and work tirelessly to ensure that the rights and dignity of intersex persons are upheld in every corner of our society.

I extend my deepest gratitude to our partners, donors, staff, and the intersex community. Your unwavering support is the cornerstone of our success. Together, we are creating a future where every intersex person can live with dignity, autonomy, and pride.

Thank you for standing with us on this journey.

In solidarity,

**Obioma Chukwuike**

***Executive Director- Intersex Nigeria***

# HUMAN RIGHTS AND ADVOCACY

*Intersex Nigeria conducts thorough research to understand the human rights issues affecting the communities we serve.*

*This involves advocacy visits, meetings, documentation of human rights violations, collation of data, and also collation of testimonies from affected individuals to build evidence for advocacy campaigns.*

# Pride Symposium

The Pride celebrations began with a Symposium focusing on the theme "Intersex and Its Narrative Within the SOGIESC Movement." Distinguished speakers included Obioma Chukwulke, Barrister Chizelu Emejuelu, a legal practitioner, Chimdinma Ike, a human rights activist, and Tosin Odunlami, an intersex activist. This symposium brought together these experts, activists, and community members to share knowledge and ideas.

Research Launch: A key highlight was the launch of the **"Beyond the Binary"** research, aiming to understand better and support individuals who do not conform to traditional gender categories.

# GALA NIGHT

The Pride event continued into an evening Gala, attended by over sixty intersex persons, human rights activists from various organizations, and queer persons.

The Gala featured performances, socialization, and celebrations of the intersex community's achievements. This joyful event highlighted the resilience and strength of the intersex and broader queer community, leaving a lasting impact on all attendees by promoting a sense of unity, pride, and empowerment.

# THE VIRAL PROJECT

In August 2023, Intersex Nigeria hosted a **Progress Meeting** for the VIRAL project, updating stakeholders on the research status and highlighting the urgency of addressing Intersex Genital Mutilation (IGM). This comprehensive study seeks to create greater visibility, inclusion, and recognition of intersex people.

The **VIRAL Project** stands for **Visibility, Inclusion, and Recognition of Intersex Persons in Nigeria and Cameroon.**

This research aims to uncover the prevalence of intersex genital mutilation (IGM) and raise awareness of its consequences, extent, and scope in Nigeria and Cameroon.

The 2nd of March 2023, marked the kick off of the VIRAL project, bringing together Human Rights Organizations, traditional rulers, religious leaders, state and non-state actors, law enforcement agents, the Human Rights Commission, and intersex persons in Nigeria. The meeting launched the VIRAL project and aiimed at raising awareness on the consequences, extent, and scope of intersex genital mutilation in Nigeria and Cameroon. Stakeholders committed to ensuring the successful implementation of the project.

**Validation of Research Reports and Costed Action Plan:** In September 2023, Intersex Nigeria hosted a Validation meeting for research reports and the development of a costed action plan, addressing challenges faced by intersex persons in Nigeria. The reports provided a solid foundation for discussions on ending IGM, emphasizing the urgent need for greater visibility, inclusion, and recognition of intersex people. The costed action plan outlined specific steps, timelines, and budget allocations to address the issues faced by intersex persons.

# THE VIRAL PROJECT (CAMEROON)

In 2023, **the VIRAL Project, which stands for Visibility, Inclusion, and Recognition of Intersex Persons,** was actively implemented in Cameroon to address the prevalence of Intersex Genital Mutilation (IGM) and raise awareness about its impact.

The project began with an **inception meeting,** where we brought together key stakeholders including human rights organizations, traditional leaders, and community members in Cameroon. This meeting was crucial for launching the project and outlining its objectives.

Following the inception meeting, we held a **progress meeting** to review the project's advancements and engage stakeholders in discussions about ongoing efforts and challenges.

The culmination of our activities in Cameroon was the **Validation of Research Reports and the Costed Action Plan.** This plan detailed actionable steps and timelines for initiatives aimed at raising awareness, advocating for policy change, and promoting legal reform to protect intersex persons.

These activities mark significant steps forward in our commitment to enhancing visibility and advancing the rights of intersex persons in Cameroon.

# Advocacy in the South - South Region of Nigeria

## Dialogue Meeting in Akwa-Ibom State

Intersex Nigeria facilitated a dialogue meeting with state and non-state actors to encourage collaboration and promote understanding of intersex issues. These meetings were crucial in building alliances and promoting a supportive environment for intersex persons.

With a shared commitment to advocacy, education, and empowerment, Intersex Nigeria addressed pressing issues surrounding harmful practices affecting Intersex persons in their diversity, Female Sex Workers (FSW), and sexual and gender minors, such as genital mutilation.
This dialogue served as a foundation for building stronger relationships between stakeholders and marginalized communities, emphasizing the importance of inclusivity and collaboration in advocacy efforts

# Radio Sensitization and Awareness

## Ikorodu FM Outreach In July 2023

Intersex Nigeria embarked on an innovative radio outreach program, starting with Ikorodu FM, a widely popular station with a broad reach across Nigeria. This initiative was designed to leverage the power of radio to engage with diverse communities, including those in remote and underserved areas, to raise awareness about intersex issues.

**Interactive Segments:** Our team carefully curated a series of engaging and informative segments aimed at educating the public about intersex variations, debunking myths and misconceptions, and highlighting the real-life experiences and challenges faced by intersex persons in Nigeria.

A live call-in segment allowed listeners to ask questions and share their thoughts, promoting a sense of community and support.

**Indigenous Languages:** The use of indigenous languages ensured that the message reached a wider audience, resonating deeply with local communities.

# STAR FM Outreach In November 2023

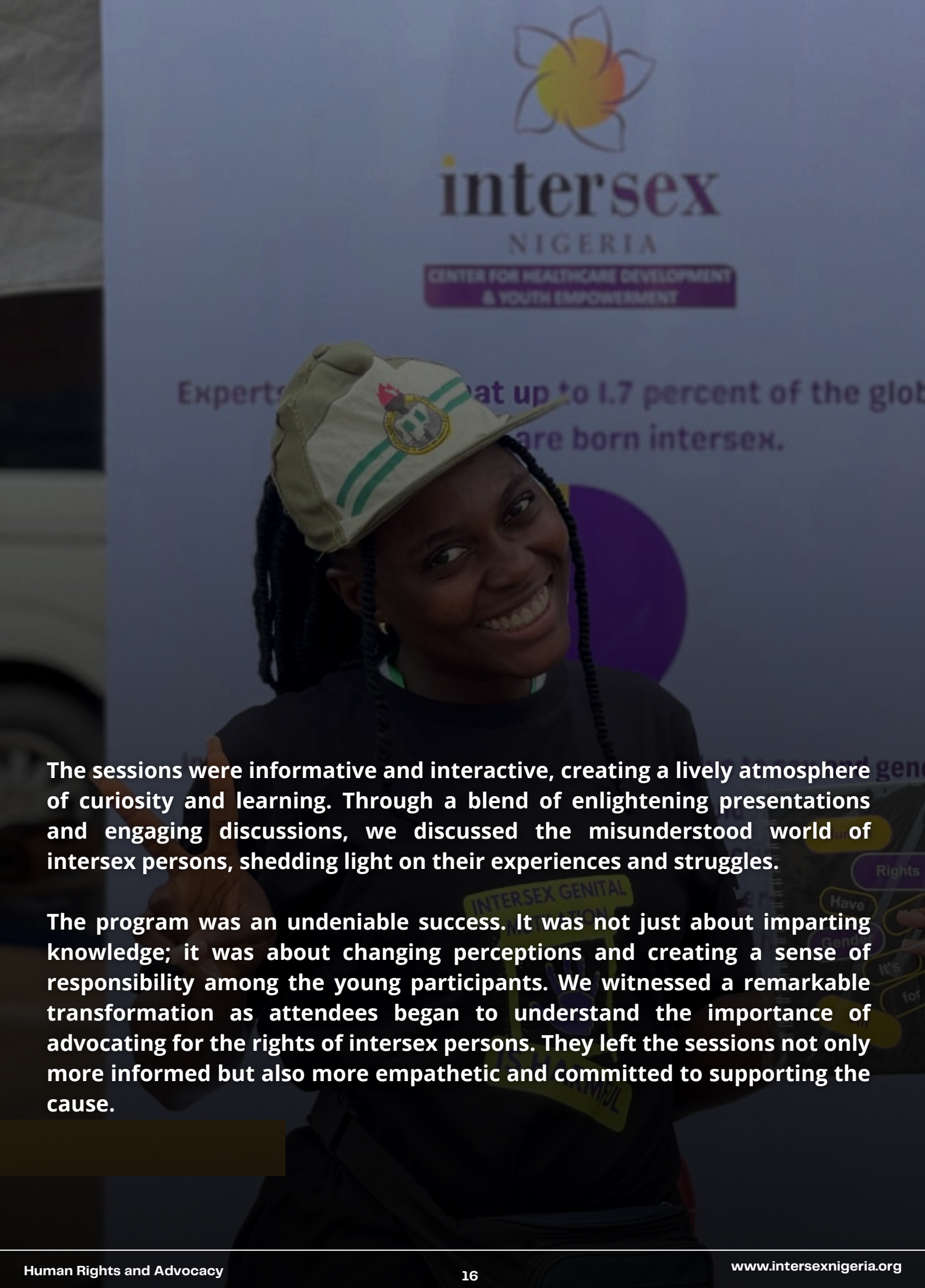
In November 2023, Intersex Nigeria continued advocacy efforts at Star FM engaging with listeners on this indigenous radio station to address intersex sexual and reproductive health and rights and also challenge stigma.

The advocacy efforts were successful, with many listeners calling in on air to have their questions answered.

# NYSC SENSITIZATION

In August 2023, Intersex Nigeria started a dynamic sensitization program focused on youths in Nigeria, starting with the **National Youth Service Orientation** Camp (NYSC) in Lagos.

This project was crafted to educate these young minds on the nuances of sex characteristics, gender identity, and the challenges faced by intersex persons.




**The sessions were informative and interactive, creating a lively atmosphere of curiosity and learning. Through a blend of enlightening presentations and engaging discussions, we discussed the misunderstood world of intersex persons, shedding light on their experiences and struggles.**

**The program was an undeniable success. It was not just about imparting knowledge; it was about changing perceptions and creating a sense of responsibility among the young participants. We witnessed a remarkable transformation as attendees began to understand the importance of advocating for the rights of intersex persons. They left the sessions not only more informed but also more empathetic and committed to supporting the cause.**

# Advancing Inclusion: Advocating for the Inclusion of People with Diverse SOGEISC in the 2030 SDG Agenda.

On the 10th of July, 2023, during the opening ceremony of the High-Level Political Forum at the United Nations General Assembly, Obioma Chukwuike, Executive Director at Intersex Nigeria delivered an intervention speech on behalf of the SOGEISC Stakeholder Group. The intervention highlighted the ongoing challenges faced by people of diverse SOGEISC, including intersex persons, in accessing the benefits of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) initiatives. As the 2030 SDG agenda reaches its midpoint, it is imperative to reflect on the inclusion and participation of diverse communities in this global framework.

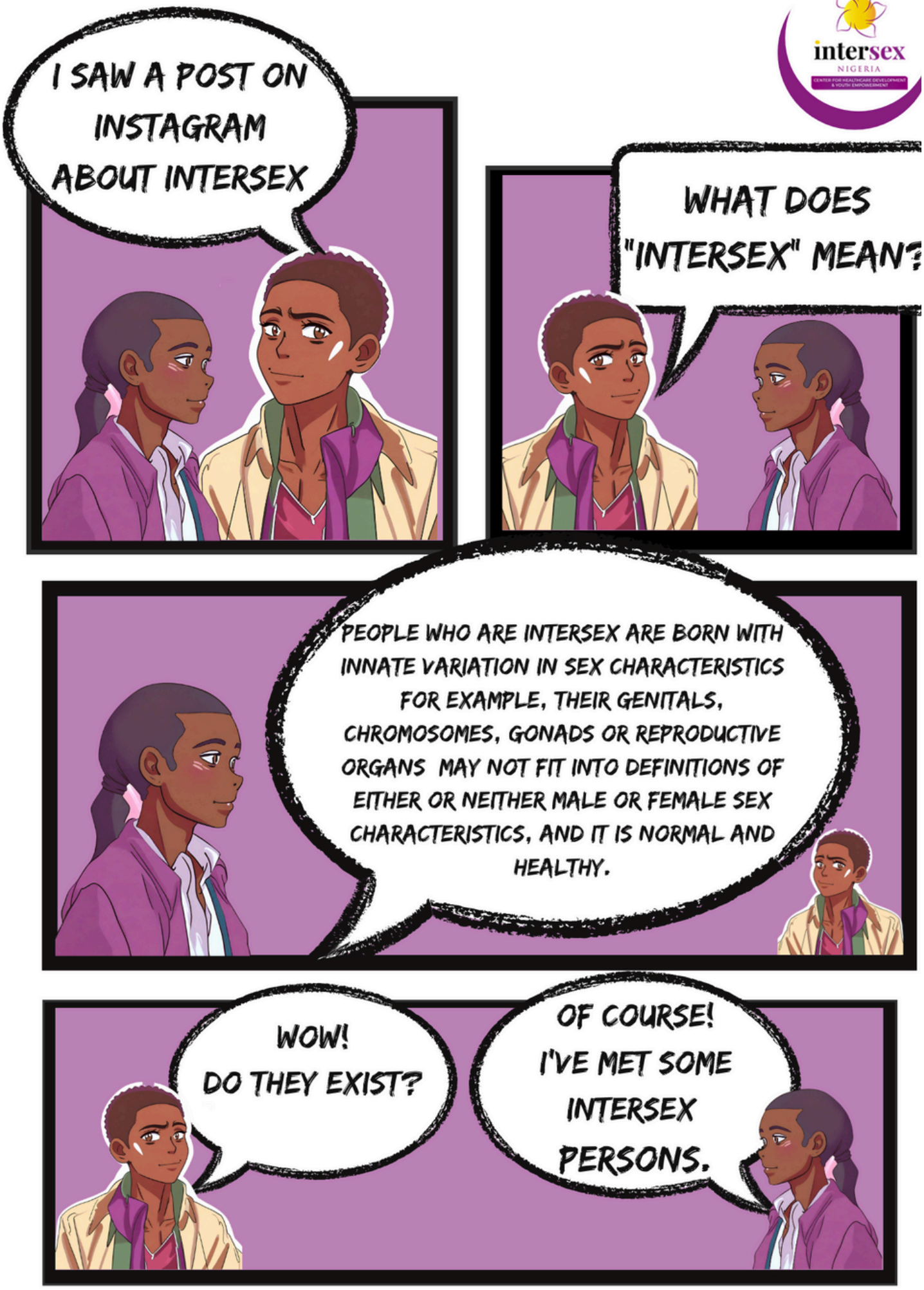
# INTERSEX AWARENESS DAY

**Pre-Event: Prior to the event, Intersex Nigeria organized various activities to raise awareness and engage the public, including online platforms for submissions of poetry and spoken words.**

**On the 26th of October, 2023, Intersex Nigeria marked Intersex Awareness Day with a vibrant and impactful event in Lagos. This celebration was more than just a gathering; it was a powerful statement of solidarity and a call to action for intersex rights**

**Intersex Awareness Day 2023 brought together a diverse group of stakeholders, activists, and allies, all united by a shared commitment to raising awareness about the rights and challenges faced by intersex persons. The awareness campaigns were meticulously planned to resonate with a broad audience, breaking down complex issues into accessible and relatable content.**

**Through heartfelt speeches and interactive sessions, we looked into the unique experiences of intersex persons, highlighting their resilience and the urgent need for societal acceptance and legal protection. In addition to the speeches and workshops, we organized creative outreach efforts that extended beyond the venue. Volunteers distributed informative materials and engaged in one-on-one conversations with passers by in bustling areas of Lagos. These grassroots efforts ensured that our message reached over 150 individuals, significantly amplifying our impact.**


I SAW A POST ON INSTAGRAM ABOUT INTERSEX
WHAT DOES "INTERSEX" MEAN?
PEOPLE WHO ARE INTERSEX ARE BORN WITH INNATE VARIATION IN SEX CHARACTERISTICS FOR EXAMPLE, THEIR GENITALS, CHROMOSOMES, GONADS OR REPRODUCTIVE ORGANS MAY NOT FIT INTO DEFINITIONS OF EITHER OR NEITHER MALE OR FEMALE SEX CHARACTERISTICS, AND IT IS NORMAL AND HEALTHY.
WOW! DO THEY EXIST?
OF COURSE! I'VE MET SOME INTERSEX PERSONS.

# INTERSEX ADVOCACY MANUAL

This workshop held in November 2023 brought together key stakeholders, including the National Human Rights Commission, right holders, allies, and various organizations dedicated to human rights and gender equality.

Participants engaged in collaborative discussions to create a comprehensive guide aimed at enhancing advocacy efforts for intersex rights. The workshop generated valuable strategies and insights to support intersex persons and promote inclusion.

# SEXUAL REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH AND RIGHTS

*Intersex Nigeria develops and implement comprehensive sexuality education programs that provide accurate information about sexual and reproductive health, including topics such as contraception, HIV and STI prevention, consent, gender equality, and reproductive rights.*
*Intersex Nigeria also provides life competency skills training for young persons with diverse SOGIESC in Nigeria.*

# ENGAGE, ENCOURAGE, EMPOWER. (EEE)

## Life Competency Skills Training for Young Adults with Diverse SOGEISC

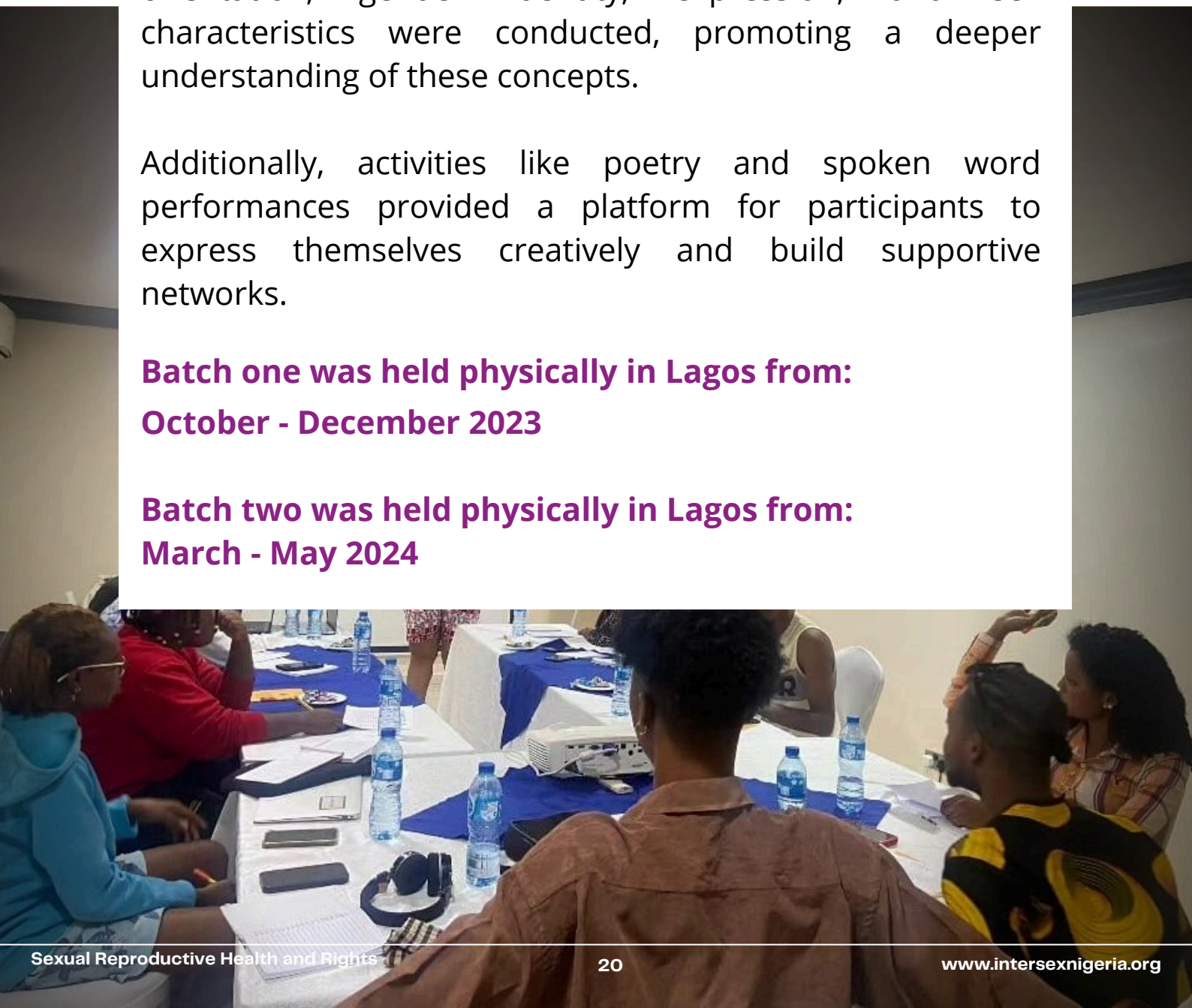
Intersex Nigeria launched this initiative in May 2023, targeting young persons with diverse SOGEISC in Nigeria.

The program aim to empower these youths through education on SOGEISC issues, psychotherapy sessions, and interpersonal skills development. Workshops on sexual orientation, gender identity, expression, and sex characteristics were conducted, promoting a deeper understanding of these concepts.

Additionally, activities like poetry and spoken word performances provided a platform for participants to express themselves creatively and build supportive networks.

**Batch one was held physically in Lagos from:**
**October - December 2023**

**Batch two was held physically in Lagos from:**
**March - May 2024**



# *Testimonials*
# From EEE participants

## Zikora Pascal

*I am the happiest person on earth to be in the program. The program helped me know my worth and stand up for myself. It made me stronger and allowed me to accept myself without seeking approval from others. This program transformed my life. I wanted to give up, but it gave me the strength to keep going and the hope that tomorrow holds great things.*

## Tosin Odunlami

*The EEE Training has greatly improved my relaxation skills through meditation, deep breathing, self-talk, sharing, and prayer.*

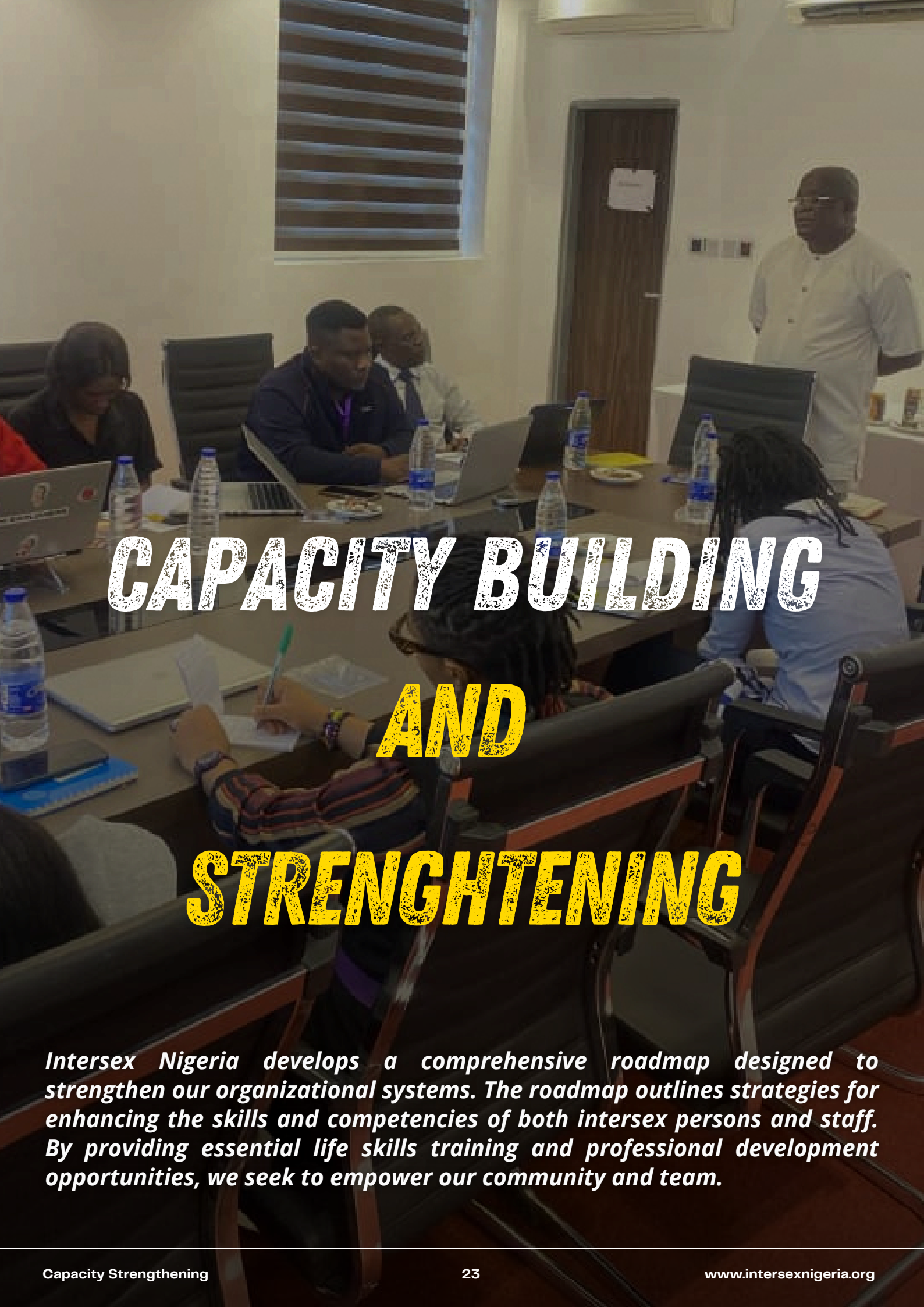
*It has enhanced my assertive and effective communication, deepening my understanding and empathy. My self-esteem is now healthier, as I accept my weaknesses and celebrate my strengths.*

*The training has helped me resolve workplace and community conflicts, understand others' emotions constructively, and differentiate between empathy and sympathy. Additionally, it has taught me emotional regulation and helped me define my core values and goals in my professional life.*

# SEXUAL AND REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH TOOLKIT

Intersex Nigeria launched this comprehensive toolkit to promote intersex rights and dispel myths about sexual and reproductive health.

The toolkit provides valuable information for healthcare providers, educators, and community leaders.



# CAPACITY BUILDING AND STRENGHTENING

*Intersex Nigeria develops a comprehensive roadmap designed to strengthen our organizational systems. The roadmap outlines strategies for enhancing the skills and competencies of both intersex persons and staff. By providing essential life skills training and professional development opportunities, we seek to empower our community and team.*

# CAPACITY STRENGTHENING

In August 2023, Intersex Nigeria conducted a comprehensive three-day capacity-strengthening training for staff.

The training sessions covered a broad range of essential topics, including **Risk Management, Fundraising Strategies,** and **Methods for measuring and reporting social impact.** These areas were identified as critical for our continued success and effectiveness in advocating for intersex rights and supporting our community. Beyond technical skills, the training promoted camaraderie and shared purpose among our staff. Interactive sessions and team-building activities encouraged collaboration and mutual support, strengthening our organizational cohesion.

**Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (PMEL) Training:** In September 2023, Intersex Nigeria held a two-day staff training on Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (PMEL) to enhance our project management and impact assessment capabilities.

**Interpersonal Skills and Project Management:** Intersex Nigeria conducted a five-day capacity training session for staff on interpersonal skills and project management, alongside trainings on safeguarding, digital ethics, and communication policy.

# ORGANIZATIONAL RETREAT

In November 2023, Intersex Nigeria hosted an organizational retreat, reaffirming our dedication to advocating for intersex rights and increasing visibility.

The retreat offered a platform for individual and collective reflection, strengthening internal connections and setting strategic goals. We evaluated past initiatives, identified areas for growth, and outlined future actions. This event underscored our commitment to enhancing public awareness and recognition of intersex rights, aiming to promote a more inclusive environment for the intersex community.

Key outcomes included a renewed emphasis on strengthening our internal structures and nurturing deeper connections among staff and stakeholders. We also explored innovative approaches to advocacy and awareness-raising, recognizing the importance of leveraging media and technology to amplify intersex voices.

# MOVEMENT BUILDING AND PARTNERSHIP

***Intersex Nigeria collaborates and networks with other rights-based organizations, activists, international organizations, and allies to build a resilient intersex movement. Together, we work to increase the visibility and recognition of intersex person, advocate for their rights, and promote inclusion on both a national and global scale.***

# Marking Community

## Meeting to Build Strategies in Response to The Emerging Anti-Gender Rights Movement in Nigeria.

Intersex Nigeria actively participated in a strategic two-day meeting to address the rise of anti-gender movements in Nigeria.

We presented on existing anti-gender laws in Nigeria and our advocacy plans for legislative changes. The meeting included regional insights from Uganda, Kenya, and Nigeria, and emphasized the importance of using platforms of anti-gender groups for pro-gender advocacy.

There were also presentations on the anti-gender movement's status in Uganda, Kenya, and Nigeria provided a comparative understanding of the regional challenges and strategies. This collaboration highlights our commitment to advancing gender rights.

# Community of Action (CoA)

## Voices For Justice Courtroom Live Show

Intersex Nigeria participated in the two-day "Voices For Justice" courtroom live show in Abuja, alongside other COA members. This flagship event, part of the **We Lead project,** commemorated the **16 Days of Activism.**

Intersex Nigeria was thrilled to be part of this initiative, which aimed to raise awareness, seek justice, and hold relevant stakeholders accountable. The event addressed systemic issues affecting all persons, especially women, girls, and gender-diverse individuals in Nigeria.

# Marking Community

## Joint Discussion on Eradicating Gender-Based Discrimination

Intersex Nigeria participated in a joint discussion organized by **Alliances for Africa** focused on eradicating gender-based discrimination and sexual harassment in tertiary institutions in Nigeria.

This insightful engagement brought together relevant stakeholders, including representatives from gender units across various tertiary institutions in Nigeria. The discussion provided a platform to share experiences, strategies, and best practices for creating safer and more inclusive educational environments. Participants explored effective policies, preventive measures, and support systems to address and eliminate gender-based discrimination and sexual harassment in academic settings.

# Challenges and Lessons Learned

## Challenges:

**Operational Hurdles:**
Logistical challenges in expanding programs to remote areas.

## Lessons Learned:

**Adaptability:**

Flexibility in approach and strategy is crucial to overcoming unexpected challenges.

**Community Involvement:**

Engaging community members and stakeholders enhances program effectiveness and sustainability.

**Continuous Learning:**

Ongoing training and capacity building for staff and volunteers are essential for organizational growth and impact.

## *Looking Forward*

# In 2024, We Aim to:

**1** ***Expand Programs:***

Reach more partners and stakeholders to increase the scope of our programs to promote intersex rights

**2** ***Strengthen Advocacy:***

Enhance our advocacy efforts at both national and international levels to promote intersex rights and awareness.

**3** ***Forge Partnerships:***

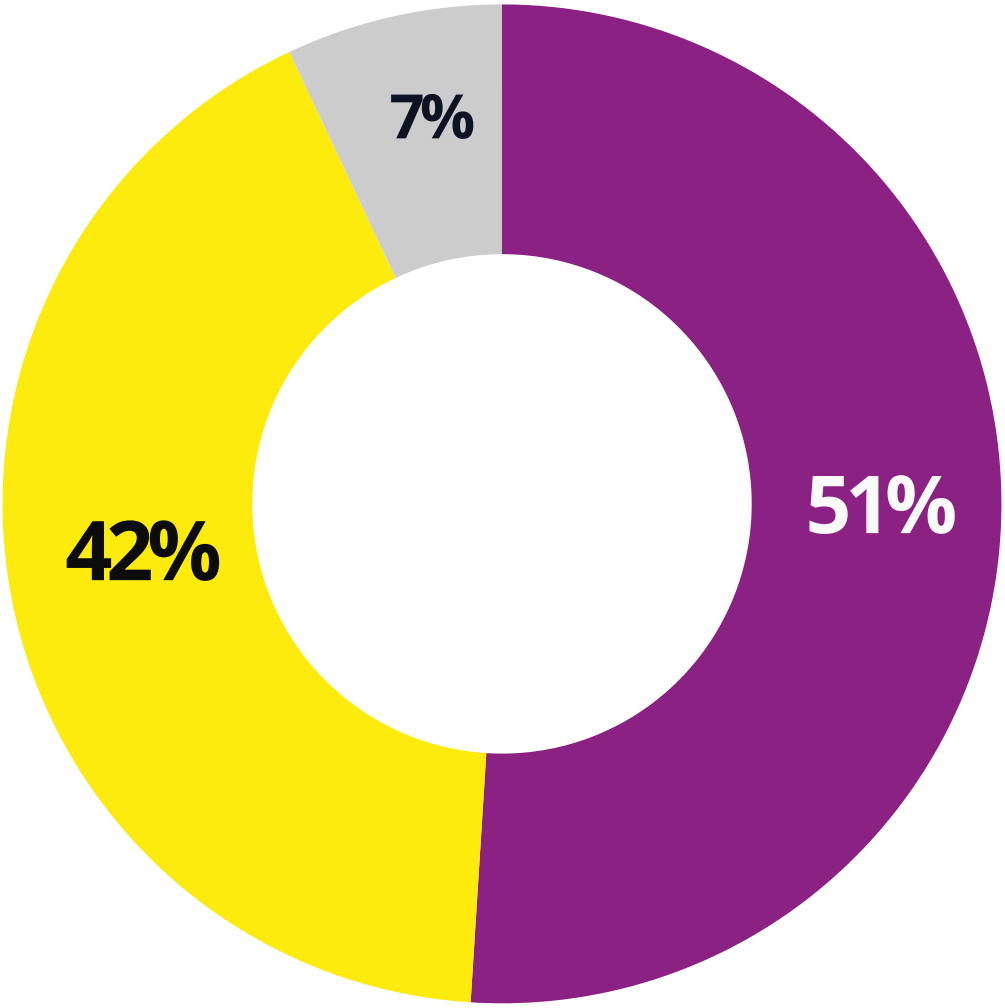
Build new partnerships with organizations, donors and stakeholders to amplify our impact.

**4** ***Empower Intersex Individuals and Ally Communities***

Continue empowering intersex individuals and allied communities through education, peer support, and community strengthening engagements.

# 2023 FINANCIAL SUMMARY

**TOTAL INCOME:** **$180,600**




| | |
|---|---|
| ***Programs Expenses:*** | $92,206 |
| ***Admin Expenses:*** | $75,582 |
| ***Surplus for the Year:*** | $12,642 |

**We Extend Our Heartfelt Appreciation to Our Partners.**

# Acknowledgements

*Intersex Nigeria (Centre for Healthcare Development and Youth Empowerment) extend our heartfelt gratitude to our donors, partners, allies, staff, interns and volunteers and the intersex community who have made our achievements possible. Your dedication and support are vital to our mission, and we look forward to continuing this journey together.*

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# *Thank You!*

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## *Stay in Touch*

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